

Isaac Palma-Medina

Tel. +352 621 651 290 | Email: isaacpalma21@gmail.com | [GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

Experience

Student Researcher & Teaching Assistant

Mar. 2026 — Present

University of Luxembourg (UniLu)

- **GPU Acceleration of Cost Function Networks** (main focus, Sept. 2026 – Present) — Investigating GPU parallelisation of CFN solving.
- **Queue-Based Performance Characterization of Hardware-Specific Partitions Across HPC Clusters** (Apr. 2026 – Present) — Developing a ReFrame-based characterization framework with teams in Luxembourg and Costa Rica.
- **Automatic Micro Weather Stations** (Mar. 2026 – Present) — Anomaly detection and data-quality analysis across a distributed meteorological sensor network in Costa Rica, with the University of Costa Rica.
 - Paper: “Cross-Method Agreement in Unsupervised Anomaly Detection across a Distributed Meteorological Sensor Network in Costa Rica,” IEEE BioInspired Processing 2026.
- **Teaching Assistant — Parallel Computing** (Sept. 2026 – Present) — Reviewing student solutions and providing in-class technical support.

Collaborator

Jul. 2024 — Sept. 2025

LHCb Experiment, European Organization for Nuclear Research (CERN)

- Co-developed the reconstruction pipeline for the full Ring Imaging Cherenkov (RICH) subdetectors, migrating processing from CPU-based code to a GPU-optimized CUDA environment within LHCb’s real-time trigger system.
- Conducted track-resolution studies between trigger stages to evaluate GPU-based reconstruction performance and support its integration and optimization.
- **Summer Student Program** (Jul. 2024 — Aug. 2024):
 - Developed monitoring algorithms to assess particle-track reconstruction resolution and data quality within the trigger system.
 - Performed scientific data analysis and visualization in Python during a two-month research stay at CERN.

Research Assistant

Sept. 2024 — Sept. 2025

National Collaboratory for Advanced Computing (CNCA), CeNAT-CONARE

- Conducted research supporting the CERN LHCb collaboration through Costa Rica’s institutional participation in the experiment.

Software Developer

Jun. 2024 — Nov. 2024

University of Costa Rica (UCR)

- Developed a digital emergency-call management system that replaced previously manual workflows.

Software Developer & Scrum Master

Mar. 2023 — Jun. 2024

9-1-1 Emergency System of Costa Rica

- Led development of a real-time staff scheduling system valued at over \$50,000 for a national emergency-services environment.

Education

University of Luxembourg (UniLu)

Sept. 2025 — Present

Master's Degree in High Performance Computing

- UniLu International Awards 2026 awardee (Ministry of Foreign Affairs).
- Full scholarship awarded by the Government of Luxembourg for academic merit and international collaboration in HPC.
- Participant in the European Master for High Performance Computing (EUMaster4HPC) track.

National University of Costa Rica (UNA)

2021 — Jun. 2025

Bachelor's Degree in Information Systems Engineering (incl. Associate Degree in Software Development, 2023)

- 2024 Distinguished Student Award — highest GPA in the program; academic excellence scholarship (9.61/10).
- Student tutor in C++ and object-oriented programming for two years; completed parallel computing electives.

Johns Hopkins University (JHU)

2024 — 2025

Non-Credit Specialization in GPU Programming (CUDA), authorized by JHU

Selected Talks & Activities

Invited Speaker — Inaugural Talk Series | IEEE Student Branch, UNA May 2026

- Delivered “From International Experience to Research: HPC and AI from Costa Rica,” introducing HPC and ongoing research projects to computer science students.

Speaker — “International Opportunities for Costa Rican Students” | UNA May 2026

- Presented international academic and research opportunities, highlighting Luxembourg–Costa Rica collaboration and HPC opportunities at UniLu.

Instructor — Introduction to High Performance Computing Workshop | UNA Feb. 2025, Apr. 2026

- Introduced HPC concepts and guided over 60 participants through hands-on supercomputer exercises across two editions.

Participant — Costa Rica Big Data School | CNCA Sept. 2025

- Completed hands-on training in Python and AI-driven data analysis using FRONTERA (TACC), covering the computational research workflow.

Teaching Assistant — Parallel Programming | LEAD University Jun. 2025 – Sept. 2025

- Evaluated assignments and provided technical feedback to students.

Participant & Local Organizing Support — CLASHEP 2025 | CERN May 2025

- Attended particle-physics lectures at the CERN Latin-American School of High-Energy Physics and supported the local organizing committee.

Participant (1st Place, Team Challenge) — Costa Rica HPC School | CNCA Jan. 2025

- Trained in Kokkos and MPI; competed in a team event of three computational optimization challenges.

Participant — Physics Without Frontiers Workshop | ICTP Dec. 2024

- Analyzed B-meson decays and CP violation using open LHCb data with Python.

Workshop Assistant — HPC and Kokkos Workshop, 42nd IEEE CONCAPAN | IEEE Nov. 2024

- Supported the workshop’s delivery and participated in conference sessions.

Instructor — Free Community Python Course | Cisco NetAcad & UNA Nov. 2023 – Feb. 2024

- Organized and delivered a Python programming course for over 100 community participants.

Languages

- Spanish — Native
- English — C1 (TOEFL Essentials)
- French — Beginner